ARGUMENT AGAINST MEASURE H

Measure H asks Solano County voters to raise the Transient Occupancy Tax, the "hotel tax" paid by visitors staying overnight in unincorporated areas - from 5 % to 12 % an 140% increase. The County claims this increase will "fund local programs and essential public services" and generate about $58,500 annually. But the money goes into the general fund where it can be spent on any purpose the Board of Supervisors chooses, with no spending guarantees. This proposal is disproportionate, unnecessary, and misleading.

A 7-point jump represents a 140 % tax increase, one of the largest hikes in California. The County's justification — that the money will support "essential services" — is vague and unverified. There is no guarantee that the funds will improve police, fire, or road maintenance. The same promise appears in nearly every tax measure, yet the money often disappears into administrative overhead.

The County's own estimate shows the increase would raise only $58,500 a year — a tiny fraction of the County's overall budget. That amount will not meaningfully improve public services, but it will make Solano County's rural lodging less competitive. Higher lodging taxes will hurt small businesses that rely on tourism. When taxes rise, visitors pay more, and local businesses lose customers, which ultimately affects residents through reduced economic activity and higher prices.

Measure H also includes the phrase "until ended by the voters." In reality, ending a tax requires a new ballot initiative and thousands of signatures collected by the voters, a process so difficult that few communities ever succeed. Once enacted, this tax will likely remain permanent.

Solano County should focus on fiscal accountability, not symbolic tax hikes that burden local tourism and mislead voters about their impact.

Vote NO on Measure H.

Solano County Taxpayers Association
s/Michael T Nolan, President

s/ Shari Borkin
Dixon/Solano County resident